JAMES WHITMORE

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GitHub: github.com/jwhitmore-dev

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Principal Engineer with six years of hands-on experience building scalable backend systems and leading technical architecture decisions at growing companies. I've spent the last three years managing teams and mentoring junior engineers while maintaining a strong focus on writing robust, maintainable code. Based in Oxford, I'm passionate about solving complex infrastructure challenges and helping teams move faster without compromising on reliability.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

CloudScale Systems Ltd

https://cloudscale.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2023 - Present

Led the architecture redesign of our core microservices platform, reducing latency by 35% and enabling the platform to handle 10x traffic growth without scaling infrastructure proportionally. Mentored a team of four junior and mid-level engineers, conducting regular code reviews and establishing coding standards that improved deployment velocity by 40%. Designed and implemented an event-driven system for real-time data processing that now handles over 2 million events per day across our customer base. Worked directly with product and infrastructure teams to define technical roadmaps for the next two years, balancing technical debt reduction with feature delivery.

Senior Software Engineer

DataFlow Analytics Ltd

https://dataflow-analytics.co

Reading, United Kingdom

August 2021 - February 2023

Built a distributed query engine in Go that reduced query execution time from minutes to seconds for customers running complex analytical workloads. Owned the database optimization project which involved profiling queries, redesigning indexes, and implementing connection pooling, resulting in a 50% reduction in database costs. Took on on-call responsibilities and reduced mean time to recovery for production incidents from 45 minutes to under 10 minutes through better observability and alerting. Implemented comprehensive logging and monitoring using Prometheus and Grafana, giving the team visibility into system behaviour that previously was causing blind spots.

Software Engineer

Vertex Digital Ltd

https://vertexdigital.net

Oxford, United Kingdom

June 2019 - July 2021

Developed REST APIs and backend services using Python and Node.js that powered features used by over 50,000 active users. Migrated the monolithic application to a microservices architecture using Docker and Kubernetes, improving deployment frequency from monthly to daily releases. Implemented automated testing pipelines with Jenkins and increased code coverage from 35% to 82%, catching bugs before they reached production. Collaborated with frontend teams to optimize API response times and reduce client-side load, improving overall user experience metrics by 28%.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Oxford

Oxford, United Kingdom

2017 - 2019

Merit classification

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Node.js, SQL, Bash, Java

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Cloud and DevOps: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Lambda), Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform

Tools and Platforms: Git, Jenkins, CircleCI, Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog

Specializations: Microservices Architecture, System Design, Database Performance Optimization, Event-Driven Systems

GITHUB REPOSITORIES

github.com/jwhitmore-dev/query-engine - Distributed query engine written in Go with support for complex analytical workloads and horizontal scaling

github.com/jwhitmore-dev/postgres-optimizer - Python toolkit for analyzing PostgreSQL query plans and suggesting optimization strategies

github.com/jwhitmore-dev/event-stream-processor - High-throughput event processing library using Go and Kafka for real-time data pipelines

github.com/jwhitmore-dev/api-gateway - Lightweight API gateway middleware written in Node.js with built-in rate limiting and request validation